people might be further confused and aggravated. The grey areas are real. "A lot of things are unclear," says Satya Ranjan Sarkar, a Matua rights activist with the Hari Guruchand Matua Mission. "Many Matuas are downtrodden people who have either lost or left everything in Bangladesh. They don't have documents to prove they lived there. Citizenship to Matuas should have been unconditional," he adds.

To allay fears, Thakur has decided to apply for citizenship himself and says Bangladeshi (or Pakistani, for pre-1971 migrations) documents have been sought for all applicants to ensure their genuineness. In its absence, he claims, "a written undertaking from a registered body" will work. The portal mentions no such alternative. Besides an eligibility certificate from "a locally reputed community institution", the rules also call for a self-declaration attested by a judicial magistrate, an executive magistrate, an oath commissioner or a notary public. This last requirement is considered vague by stakeholders and experts, "tantamount to a confession of being a foreigner". That's what allows TMC chief Mamata Banerjee to create some resonance with her colourful allegation that the CAA is a trap to identify people as "foreigners"—she repeated the charge at a rally in Tehatta on May 2. Worryingly for the BJP, Mamata's rallies are attracting large Matua crowds. Anirban Halder, a Matua BJP leader in Barasat, admits the requirements of Section 1A—which can end up frustrating the hopes of many—can deplete BJP vote share and help the TMC. Mamata also claims applicants would be immediately deprived of all government benefits. While insisting the law doesn't entail that, experts admit to a lack of clarity—including on "what happens after the hearings for applicants", as hinted at by former Supreme Court judge Ashok Kumar Ganguly. Mahasangha general secretary Mohitosh Baidya says applications from interested Matuas are being collected and will be uploaded to the portal after the polls. "We have convinced people about the delay. I have collected some 50 names from Barasat. There is no confusion," he says.

**AN IMPLACABLE CRITIC OF CAA, MAMATA'S RALLIES ARE NOW ATTRACTING LARGE MATUA CROWDS. CHANCES OF A DEPLETING VOTE SHARE IS A WORRYING CONCERN FOR THE BJP**

Over three million strong, Matuas dominate the Lok Sabha constituencies of Bongaon, Ranaghat, Barasat and parts of Krishnanagar—the BJP won the first two in 2019 primarily on its promise of enacting the CAA. The law came in December 2019, but its rules were not framed until March 2024. The TMC tried to play up the delay during the 2021 polls, but the BJP still won nine of the 10 Matua-dominated assembly seats. It's the first four that are stake now. ■



V H GROUP

Venky's

## Clarification: Use Of Antibiotic In Venky's Chicken

It is observed that few media companies have published a story alleging that Venky's chicken has a heavy dosing of antibiotics in it. The said story was aired on Live TV and also circulated through social media platforms. At the outset we wish to clarify that such statement made by the media houses are unfounded, inaccurate and in contrast with the facts.

Venky's is a pioneer in the Indian Poultry Industry and has been providing high quality chicken to its consumers for more than 4 decades. One of the products sold by Venky's is processed and ready to eat chicken (Venky's Chicken Products) which is made in state-of-the art processing units having highest standard of production practices which are in strict compliance with the FSSAI norms. Our chicken processing units are having internationally recognized certifications such as HACCP and FSSC 22000.

Venky's Chicken products are made from internally sourced chicken meat coming from birds raised in house or grown through contract farming supervised by Venky's.

We can proudly state that the birds used for making Venky's Chicken products are not fed with antibiotics on preventive basis or as growth promoter.

The meat used for making Venky's Chicken Products is periodically tested from FSSAI approved NABL accredited laboratories for antibiotics residue as per FSSAI norms. We state that Venky's Chicken Products are in compliance with FSSAI antibiotics residue norms.

We appeal to all our consumers not to believe such misleading media reports which are published without due research and verification. Issued in the interest of all customers of Venky's and the public in general.

**For Venky's (India) Limited**
Company Secretary